

Clean & Maintain

Gym Ergometer Cleaning & Maintenance Service
Business Plan — March 2026

The opportunity: No Concept2-specialized maintenance service exists in Portugal. The UK has Rowgear (£70/machine). The USA has Erg Doctor. Lisbon has nothing equivalent. 16 CrossFit boxes + ~150-200 boutique studios are the target market.

Service	Market	Competitors	Starter Cost	Revenue Model
Ergometer maintenance + free weight rust restoration	16 CrossFit boxes ~150-200 boutique studios in Lisbon	None for Concept2 ergs in Portugal (FFitness targets big gym chains)	€175-280 kit + drill (optional €50-95)	Retainer €15-25/machine/mo or per visit €80-150

1. Market Overview

Segment	Count (Lisbon)	Notes
CrossFit affiliated boxes	16	High erg density — 5-12 ergs per box on average
Boutique fitness studios	~150-200	Rowing/ski studios growing; estimate, not verified
Condo / corporate gyms	Unknown	Lower erg count but less price-sensitive
Total gyms (Greater Lisbon)	~589	28% of Portugal's ~2,370 total (companydata.com)

Known CrossFit Boxes in Lisbon

- Matchbox CrossFit
- XXI CrossFit
- Off Limits CrossFit Rato
- The Bakery CrossFit
- Trend CrossFit
- Quimera Fitness (QSC Fitness)
- ~10 others in the Wodily affiliate directory

Competitors

Company	Focus	Pricing	Gap
FFitness (Lisbon)	Large cardio/resistance fleets (Technogym, FFittech brand)	From €69.90+VAT /month	Not CrossFit-focused. No erg specialist.
Technogym Portugal	Their own equipment only	Contact-based	Brand-locked. Ignores CrossFit.
Rowgear (UK)	Concept2 specialists	£70/machine	UK only. No Portugal.
Erg Doctor (USA)	Concept2 + Assault Bikes	Not public	USA only.

No Concept2-specialized maintenance company identified in Portugal. This is the gap to own.

2. Service Menu & Pricing

Tier 1 — Deep Clean

- Full exterior wipe-down (frame, seat, footrests, handles, straps)
- Monorail cleaning with non-abrasive scouring pad + glass cleaner
- Fan blade and crevice brushing (Assault/Echo Bikes)
- Disinfection of all contact surfaces (70% isopropanol)
- Visual inspection + written service report with before/after photos

Pricing	Price
Per machine (one-off)	€25-35/machine
Monthly retainer	€15/machine/month

Tier 2 — Clean + Maintenance (Recommended)

- Everything in Tier 1, plus:
- Chain lubrication (Concept2: mineral oil or 3-IN-ONE, every 50h of use)
- Flywheel dust removal (vacuum inside mesh cage)
- Hardware tightness check (Allen key set + pedal wrench)
- SkiErg cord inspection (check for twisting)
- Strap and footrest condition check
- Firmware check via Concept2 Utility app
- Detailed service report: condition rating, recommended follow-ups

Pricing	Price
Per machine (one-off)	€50-70/machine
Monthly retainer	€20-25/machine/month
Example: 8 ergs on retainer	€160-200/month

Tier 3 — Full Service + Rust Restoration

- Everything in Tier 2, plus:
- Barbell rust removal (vinegar soak, wire brush, re-oil)
- Kettlebell sanding + re-oiling
- Dumbbell restoration (rubber or cast iron)
- Deep rust treatment with wire wheel
- Surface refinishing to protect against future corrosion

Pricing	Price
Barbells	€15-25/bar (depending on rust severity)
Kettlebells	€8-15/bell

Dumbbells	€5-10/pair
Free weights add-on to retainer	+€30-50/month

Example Package — Typical CrossFit Box

5 rowers + 1 ski erg + 1 bike erg + 1 Assault Bike + 15 barbells

8 ergs @ Tier 2 retainer (€20/machine): **€160/month**

Barbell maintenance add-on: **€40/month**

Total: ~€200/month | Annual value: €2,400

Replacing one Concept2 RowErg = ~€1,100. Preventive maintenance pays for itself.

3. Maintenance Protocols

Concept2 RowErg / SkiErg / BikeErg — Per Visit Checklist

1. Wipe full exterior — frame, monorail, seat, footrests, straps, handles
2. Monorail: glass cleaner or diluted Simple Green on non-abrasive scouring pad
3. Monitor: dry cloth ONLY — no liquids, no spray
4. Chain: 1 tsp mineral oil on paper towel, wipe full chain length (every 50h of use)
5. Flywheel: vacuum dust from inside mesh cage (every 250h or quarterly for busy boxes)
6. Hardware: check all bolts and screws for tightness (Allen key + pedal wrench)
7. SkiErg: inspect cord for twisting — untwist by turning handle opposite direction
8. Disinfect all contact surfaces with 70% isopropanol or diluted bleach

Maintenance Frequency by Task

Task	Frequency	Skill Level
Exterior wipe-down + disinfection	Every use / every visit	Low
Chain lubrication	Every 50h of use (~weekly in busy box)	Low
Flywheel dust removal	Every 250h (~quarterly)	Medium
Hardware tightness check	Monthly	Low
SkiErg cord inspection	Monthly	Low
Foot stretcher / strap inspection	Monthly	Low
Shock cord replacement	As needed	Medium
PM5 firmware / battery	As needed	Low
Barbell rust restoration	As needed	Medium
Kettlebell sanding + re-oiling	As needed	Low-Medium

What to NEVER Use on Concept2 Equipment

- ✗ WD-40 on chains — solvent, strips lubrication, attracts dirt
- ✗ Alcohol on microfiber suede grips — degrades adhesive, causes peeling
- ✗ Direct spray of any liquid on monitors or electronics
- ✗ Undiluted bleach on the monorail
- ✗ Steam directly on flywheel housing, bearings, or electronics
- ✗ Coarse abrasives on any surface

4. Starter Kit

Everything needed to start servicing Concept2 ergs professionally. Available at Leroy Merlin or Amazon.pt.

Item	Purpose	Est. Cost (EUR)
Simple Green concentrate 1L	Frame + surface cleaning (diluted)	€10-15
70% isopropanol spray 500ml	Disinfection of contact surfaces	€5-8
White vinegar 2L	Rust soak for barbells/kettlebells	€3-5
Mild dish soap	General wipe-downs	€2-3
Mineral oil 500ml	Concept2 chain lubrication (official rec.)	€5-8
3-IN-ONE oil 200ml	Chain + barbell maintenance	€6-8
WD-40 (small can)	Surface rust loosening only — NOT for chains	€5-7
Microfiber cloths x20	All wipe-downs	€10-15
Stiff nylon brushes x3	Knurling cleaning, chain	€6-10
Brass wire brush	Light rust, knurling	€5-8
Steel wire brush	Heavy rust removal	€5-8
Non-abrasive scouring pads x10	Monorail cleaning	€3-5
Soft detail brushes x3	Fan blades, crevices	€5-8
Magic erasers x10	Kettlebell handles, surfaces	€5-8
Allen key set 2-10mm	Hardware tightening	€10-15
15mm pedal wrench	BikeErg pedal bolts	€8-12
Sandpaper assortment 240+400 grit	Rust sanding on barbells/kettlebells	€5-8
Shop vac / handheld vac	Flywheel dust removal (narrow nozzle)	€30-50
Flashlight / headlamp	Flywheel cage inspection	€10-15
Spray bottles x3	Diluted cleaner preparation	€5-8
Nitrile gloves (box of 50)	Hand protection	€8-12
Plastic cling film	Wrap barbells for vinegar rust soak	€3-5
Carry bag or toolbox	Transport to client sites	€15-30
TOTAL		€175-280

Optional: corded drill + wire wheel attachment for heavy rust — add €50-95 if not already owned.

Advanced Tools (Phase 2 — Once You Have 3+ Regular Clients)

Tool	Use	Cost	Verdict
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Portable air compressor	Blow dust out of flywheel cages (faster than vacuum alone). Best used as blow + vacuum combo.	€40-80	Add in Phase 2. Shop vac alone is fine to start.
Steam cleaner	Floor stands, rubber mats, Assault Bike frame. NOT for chain, monitors, or flywheel housing.	€50-150	Only if adding floor/mat cleaning. Not needed for erg service.

5. Action Plan

Phase 1 — March 2026 (Current)

1. Buy starter kit (~€175-280) at Leroy Merlin or Amazon.pt
2. Practice on own equipment or volunteer at a local CrossFit box — document before/after
3. Draft outreach message and contact 5 CrossFit boxes in Lisbon
4. Offer 2-3 free demo visits — document with before/after photos
5. Build case study from demo visits

Phase 2 — April 2026

1. Close first monthly retainer contract (target: €120-200/month, 1 CrossFit box)
2. Use service report template for every visit — builds professionalism and trust
3. Register NIF if not already active (portaldasfinancas.gov.pt) — free
4. Register CAE 81220 + 33190 if operating commercially
5. Add air compressor to kit (once doing 3+ boxes regularly)

Phase 3 — May 2026+

1. Expand to barbell and kettlebell rust restoration as paid add-on
2. Target boutique studios and condo gyms (higher value per visit, less price-sensitive)
3. Build social proof — Instagram before/after transformations spread in tight-knit CrossFit communities
4. Consider floor maintenance add-on (Phase 4) — only after erg service is proven

Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Low awareness — gyms don't know they need this	Free demo visit removes the commitment barrier entirely
Pricing resistance	Start per-visit, convert to retainer once trust is built
Equipment variety (non-Concept2 brands)	Start Concept2-only, expand to Assault/Echo Bikes as you learn them
Liability if something breaks during service	Document machine condition before + after every single visit
Seasonal slow periods (summer gym closures)	Target condo/corporate gyms that operate year-round

6. Revenue Projections

Conservative Scenario (Month 6)

Clients	Ergs/Client	Rate/Erg/Month	Monthly Revenue
3 CrossFit boxes	8 avg	€20	€480
1 boutique studio	4 avg	€22	€88
Free weights add-on (2 clients)	—	€40 flat	€80
Total			€648/month

Starter kit (~€250) is recovered after ~1 month with first client.

Growth Scenario (Month 12)

Clients	Ergs/Client	Rate/Erg/Month	Monthly Revenue
8 CrossFit boxes	8 avg	€20	€1,280
4 boutique studios	4 avg	€22	€352
Free weights add-on (6 clients)	—	€40 flat	€240
Total			€1,872/month

UK benchmark (Rowgear): £70/machine per service with 12-month warranty on work. Portuguese pricing adjusted downward but the model is proven.